

THE EARLY YEARS CURRICULUM

In Nursery your child will be working towards the Early Learning Goals. They are expected to have achieved these by the end of the Kindergarten year.

‘There are seven areas of learning and development that must shape educational programmes in early years settings. All the areas of learning are important and inter-connected. These areas are particularly crucial for igniting children’s curiosity and enthusiasm for learning, and for building their capacity to learn, form relationships and thrive.’

EYFS
(2012)

SEVEN AREAS OF LEARNING & DEVELOPMENT

THE PRIME AREAS

Communication and Language

- Children will speak and listen to others and maintain attention.
- Children will be encouraged to listen to stories and rhymes and behave as readers.
- Children's use of language will become more proficient and their vocabulary will continue to extend.

Physical Development

- Children will learn to move with confidence in a number of ways, negotiating space successfully.
 - They will become more skilful at climbing and using equipment, e.g., catching a ball.
 - They will use one-handed tools and equipment safely with increasing control, including holding a pencil effectively.
 - They will learn handwriting patterns and how to write their name in a cursive script.
 - They will practise manipulative skills, e.g., cooking and threading.
 - The children will become aware of being healthy and how to maintain good health.
- Children will take increasing responsibility for managing their own hygiene and when putting on their coat.

Personal, Social and Emotional Development

- Children will learn to play cooperatively with others and will form good relationships with peers and familiar adults. They will learn to share and take turns with resources and play games together.
- They will gain increasing independence, including selecting their own activities.
- They will develop their confidence to try new activities and talk to others. Children will become more aware of their own feelings and those of other people; and understand appropriate behaviour and the implications of their behaviour towards others.

THE SPECIFIC AREAS

Literacy

- Children will engage in rhyming, rhythmic and alliterative activities.
- They will listen to poems, rhymes, songs, stories and non-fiction books.
- They will become aware of the features of stories.
- They will begin to make marks and ascribe meaning to these marks. Children will begin to learn letter-sounds and write these when they are ready. They will also learn to recognise words.

Mathematics

- Children will learn to recite numbers.
- They will learn to represent numbers using fingers, marks on paper or pictures.
- They will begin to recognise numbers and count objects through the use of number stories and rhymes.
- They will compare two groups of objects.
- Children will develop their mathematical vocabulary, for example shape, position and measure.
- They will explore patterns and create their own.

Understanding the World

This encompasses finding out about people and community, their physical world and technology.

- The children will be encouraged to talk about significant events in their own life and their family and find out about other people's experiences.
- They will begin to find out about different ways of life and join in with various celebrations.
- They will observe and find out about their environment and the natural world, including plants, animals, natural and found objects.
- Children will learn to operate technological equipment, including computers and cameras.

Expressive Arts and Design

- Children will be encouraged to explore and to play with a range of materials and media as well as be imaginative when they build, paint, draw etc.
- Children will learn to sing familiar songs and dance.
- They will explore musical instruments and explore how sounds change.
- They will explore colour & texture, e.g., mixing paint.
- Children will build objects and use tools for a purpose.
- They will capture experiences and responses with a range of media.
- Children will engage in imaginative role-play with their peers, e.g., going to the seaside.

NOTES FOR PARENTS - NURSERY CLASS

School Day

There is a staff member on duty at the Middle Gate and in the classroom from 8.30a.m. Nursery session times are as follows: MORNING 8.30a.m. - 12.00p.m. LUNCH 12.00p.m. - 1.00p.m. AFTERNOON 1.00p.m. - 3.00p.m.

All Nursery children are dismissed from the Middle Gate at the end of their session.

Telephone messages left on the answer phone are listened to at regular intervals during the day.

Children are provided daily with a drink of milk or water and fruit in the Early Years snack area.

We ask parents for a small donation of fruits or vegetables each week.

Any problems concerning School lunches should be discussed with the School Caterers' Head Chef.

No jewellery or watches permitted. No money or valuables should be brought to School. If it is unavoidable then such items should be given to a member of the Early Years staff for safe keeping. Sweets and toys should not be brought to School. Younger children especially get very upset if toys are lost or broken – there are plenty of toys in class.

In the event of a mislaid book a donation of £5 will be requested to purchase a replacement copy.

Medicine

If medicine needs to be given during the day it should be handed to Mrs James with clear instructions written on the Medicine Authorisation Form obtainable from the office. Please do not ask for any aspirin based products to be given.

Home Message Book

Parents are asked to look at the “Home Message Book” daily. All messages must be signed. Parents may use the book to write any messages to the teacher. Please write messages at the front of the book.

At the back of the book parents are asked to write contact numbers, work numbers etc. so that we will be able to get in touch in case of illness or emergency.

Collection of Children

Arrangements for collection of children should be noted with telephone numbers. The Early Years staff should be informed of any changes in rotas or if a child is to go home with someone else. Nannies, au pairs etc should be introduced to the Early Years staff.

WE WILL NOT ALLOW CHILDREN TO LEAVE SCHOOL WITH PEOPLE WE DO NOT KNOW

Please do not park on the zig-zag lines or obstruct neighbours' driveways.

Clothing

All clothing and belongings should be clearly marked with the child's name.

This includes shoes and plimsolls. Plimsolls should be black elasticated or Velcro. A complete change of clothing should be named and kept in your child's shoe bag – especially pants and socks. All nursery children should wear the School jogging top and bottoms and School navy polo shirt and maroon cotton socks.

All children should also have the School regulation long-sleeved painting overall and School book bag. All uniform is available from Unismart Ltd, 5 Oakdene Parade, Cobham KT11 2LR (01932 868233).

Shoe bags, which are left in School, can be purchased from the office.

Children entering nursery should be clean and dry as this encourages total independence, although the Early Years staff are used to dealing with the occasional accident. Please see our Intimate Care policy if your child will need assistance with toileting.

Reports

These are sent to parents at the end of the Autumn and Summer terms and there is a Parents' Evening at the end of the Spring term. However parents should not wait for an official Parents' Evening if they or their child have a concern. Teachers are happy to see parents before or after School whenever the need arises. There will be an opportunity to informally meet the teachers during the first half of the Autumn term in the Early Years.

Discipline

This is firm but not rigid. Good manners are expected at all times. Discipline problems would be discussed with a parent at an early stage.